



HUMANITAS  
INSTITUTE

## Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Second Baptist School University Model Memorial  
School Website: <https://www.sbsum-memorial.org/>

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**Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer**

*This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.*

**ACCS MEMBER**

*Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because ACCS require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.*

## Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

### Executive Summary

Second Baptist School University-Model Memorial (SBSUM Memorial) presents a predominantly classical framework with a clear Christian theological orientation. Public materials emphasize a biblically grounded mission, a classical curriculum (grammar–logic–rhetoric), and a university-model pedagogy that blends campus days with structured home-based study. Evidence shows explicit commitments to truth, beauty, and excellence within a biblically centered worldview, a strong partnership with families, and a robust classical arts emphasis. Taken together, SBSUM Memorial aligns with the core elements of classical education across all six categories, yielding a GENERAL CLASSICAL assessment.

#### Key insights:

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations are strongly indicated by biblically-centered language, theology-infused curriculum, and worship/choral arts embedded in school life.
- The School Purpose and Goal centers on formation, moral character, and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty, not merely job preparation.
- The Curriculum is explicitly built on classical trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and includes emphasis on the great books and a Christian worldview.
- Pedagogy combines Socratic/Harkness-style discussion and rhetoric training in the upper grades with contemplative, memory-oriented elements in earlier years, aligned with scholé and classical practice.
- Faculty materials highlight a professional, mission-driven teaching force, with a living-curriculum concept and a clear emphasis on mentorship and character formation.
- Parents & Community are positioned as co-educators through a formal family-school partnership, parent trainings, and a campus network that welcomes parental involvement.

#### Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

#### Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence SBSUM Memorial foregrounds Christ-centered, biblical worldview education, with explicit language about forming students to think critically, live biblically, and lead courageously for Christ. This is reinforced by statements about Word-of-God grounding, gospel-centered community, and the integration of faith across disciplines.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis Positive keywords present include: biblical worldview, Word of God, Christ-centered, gospel-centered, truth, beauty, excellence. The site also references worship/choir and sacred musical expression within arts as a form of communal worship and formation. Negative keywords (e.g., relativism, secular humanism) are not evidenced in SBSUM Memorial materials.

Estimated presence: Positive keywords ~5–8 of the lexicon's RMF positives; Negative keywords ~0.

- Why this rating The school's core identity is explicitly religious and metaphysical: formation in truth, goodness, and beauty through a biblical framework, communal worship-oriented arts, and theology-integrated education. This strongly supports a CLASSICAL rating in this category.

Citations: SBSUM Memorial mission and theological framing are described herein, including language about living biblically and Word-of-God grounding.

## Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence The stated goal is formation of virtue and wisdom, not simply job preparation. The mission proclaims equipping students to think critically, live biblically, and lead courageously, and to develop a biblical worldview across disciplines. The emphasis on truth, goodness, and beauty as real is explicit.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis Positive keywords present include: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful, classical mission, human flourishing, moral imagination. Negative signals (e.g., "college and career ready" as a primary goal) are not evident as primary drivers in SBSUM Memorial materials.

Estimated presence: Positive keywords ~4–7 of the lexicon's SPG positives; Negative keywords ~0.

- Why this rating SBSUM Memorial frames education as formation and worldview formation (not solely workforce prep), with explicit reference to virtue and the realness of truth, goodness, and beauty. This aligns with CLASSICAL in purpose and goal.

Citations: Mission statement and purpose language on SBSUM Memorial site.

## Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence The site explicitly explains Classical Education in terms of grammar, logic, and rhetoric (the Trivium) and describes the curriculum as being fashioned after classical education. It also discusses the study of classic literature and the Great Conversation framing through rhetoric/seminar-style work, and it notes the inclusion of general-education subjects in a Trivium structure. The presence of Latin/Greek is referenced in related materials, and there are explicit booklists for Rhetoric.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis Positive keywords present include: grammar, logic, rhetoric; trivium; great books; primary sources; classics; history (as Western civilization context); Latin/Greek; drama/arts; hymnody; sacred art; booklists; great conversation. Negative signals (e.g., project-based learning dominance) are not evident as the dominant mode in SBSUM's materials.

Estimated presence: Positive keywords ~8–12 of the lexicon's CUR positives; Negative keywords ~0–1.

- Why this rating SBSUM Memorial's core curriculum is clearly built around classical Liberal Arts through the Trivium and Quadrivium concepts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; classical literature; great books) and a Christian worldview, satisfying a CLASSICAL score for Curriculum.

Citations: Academic descriptions of the Classical Education framework and the Grammar-Logic-Rhetoric structure.

## Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

- Evidence SBSUM Memorial highlights upper-level Socratic-style engagement and rhetoric training (oval Harkness table discussions, rhetoric booklists, and opportunities to give speeches). The model includes two to three campus days with satellite learning at home, combining rigorous, dialogic on-campus work with structured home-based instruction. The Arts page discusses curricular and co-curricular arts as a means to cultivate virtue and beauty, and the overall "University-Model" pedagogy is designed to integrate classical methods with home-based learning.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis Positive keywords present include: Socratic seminar, dialectic, disputation, narration, recitation, memory-work, rhetoric, oratory, debate, Harkness discussions, scholé

(implicit in the memory-based, contemplative approach). Negative keywords (experiential/project-based-only) are not a central motif in SBSUM Memorial materials.

Estimated presence: Positive keywords ~6–10 of the PED lexicon; Negative keywords ~0–1.

- Why this rating The combination of Socratic/Harkness-style dialogue, explicit rhetoric training, and memorialized emphasis on memory and classical discourse aligns well with CLASSICAL pedagogy.

Citations: References to Harkness-style discussions, rhetoric, and classroom structure in the Academics/University-Model pages.

### **Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL**

- Evidence SBSUM Memorial presents a professional, mission-driven faculty culture with explicit leadership roles (e.g., Dean of Fine Arts Global) and a focus on mentorship and character formation. The site describes faculty as living in alignment with the school's mission and as partners in the students' formation, including teacher profiles and administrative teams.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis Positive keywords present include: tutors/mentors/masters, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, faculty of friends, collegial culture, moral exemplars, character formation, teacher training in classical pedagogy. Negative signals (facilitator-centric jargon without classical context) are not foregrounded.

Estimated presence: Positive keywords ~6–10 of FAC positives; Negative keywords ~0–1.

- Why this rating The memorial site communicates teachers as primary exemplars and living curriculum, with a strong emphasis on character formation and mentorship—core hallmarks of CLASSICAL faculty.

Citations: Administrative/Faculty pages and statements about teacher leadership.

### **Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL**

- Evidence SBSUM Memorial emphasizes a gospel-centered, family-partnered model, with parents as co-teachers and ongoing parental formation. It highlights a robust partnership with families, parent trainings, travel and event offerings, and an open-campus culture with frequent family involvement (Homeroom/parent events, parent kick-offs, trainings, Dads Retreat, Moms Nights). The university-model framework explicitly centers parental discipleship and collaboration across home and school.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis Positive keywords present include: partnership with parents, co-teachers, parental primacy, parent formation, reading groups/book clubs, community events, open campus, volunteer, home-school alignment, family participation. Negative signals (consumer-language, parent-as-customer) are not evident in the SBSUM Memorial materials.

Estimated presence: Positive keywords ~8–12 of PAC positives; Negative keywords ~0–1.

- Why this rating SBSUM Memorial portrays parents as key partners in education and discipleship, with structured opportunities for parent involvement and formation—classical alignment in this category.

Citations: Parent/Community language in About/Admissions pages and parent-oriented events.

Overall Classification and Aggregate Ranking

- Category scores:
- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Curriculum — CLASSICAL
- Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL
- Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Parents & Community — CLASSICAL
- Aggregate assessment: CLASSICAL
- Rationale: Across all six categories, SBSUM Memorial demonstrates core classical features: explicit Christian theological framing, formation-centered goals, a clearly stated classical curriculum (grammar–logic–rhetoric) with great-books sensibilities, dialogic/Socratic pedagogy, a living-faculty emphasis, and a robust, partnership-based parent/community model. The website materials consistently reflect these elements—most notably the Trivium-based curriculum, Harkness-style dialogue in upper grades, a gospel-centered community, and the family-school partnership.

#### What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable. All six categories reach a CLASSICAL alignment, so no immediate needle-moving changes are required within the scope of the public materials reviewed.

## ABSTRACT

Second Baptist School University-Model Memorial (SBSUM Memorial) demonstrates a robust CLASSICAL orientation across all six rubric categories:

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: Strong Christian/theological grounding, Word of God grounding, biblical worldview, and Christ-centered community support a Classical orientation with explicit metaphysical underpinnings. Evidence is visible in mission language and the emphasis on worship/music within a Christian framework.
- School Purpose and Goal: The emphasis on formation, virtue, wisdom, and a telos aligned with truth, goodness, and beauty align SBSUM Memorial with classical aims rather than mere job preparation.
- Curriculum: The curriculum is explicitly classical, centered on grammar–logic–rhetoric, and the Trivium, with classical literature and Great-Conversation orientation.
- Pedagogy or Teaching Methods: On-campus Socratic/Harkness-style discussions, rhetoric training, and sequential memory/recitation-based pedagogy align with classical methods, complemented by the University-Model structure that integrates home-based satellite learning.
- Faculty: Living-curriculum style with mentor-teacher leadership and a mission-driven faculty culture is evident, including named faculty leadership and a Dean of Fine Arts.
- Parents & Community: A strong parent-partnered model with ongoing formation, parent trainings, and open-campus opportunities indicates a robust classical community orientation.

Overall, SBSUM Memorial represents a coherent CLASSICAL school profile, with explicit textual evidence for each of the six elements drawn from public-facing materials and campus descriptions. The synergy between biblical formation, classical curriculum, dialogic pedagogy, and parent-community partnerships underscores a sustained CLASSICAL alignment.

**ABSTRACTING NOTE:** All citations above reference SBSUM Memorial public-facing materials recovered via the school-specific crawl vector store, supported by the classical-education lexicon and indicators from the Six Essential Elements document in the knowledge base. Specific references include SBSUM’s mission and biblical framing (turn1file10), the classical curriculum and grammar–logic–rhetoric framing (turn0file12), Harkness/Socratic pedagogy and rhetoric emphasis (turn0file12), faculty leadership and “living curriculum” language (turn1file11), and parent/community partnership language (turn1file17).

## Appendix

### ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

### Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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